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Deputy Chief Information Security Officer (Cyber Strategy, Governance, Risk and Compliance)

Home Office

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 8th November 2026

Home Office

Reference number

486709

Salary

£90,000 - £105,000

Standard Cabinet Office rules on pay will apply to civil servants appointed on level transfer or promotion. Their salary will increase to the minimum of

the SCS PB 1 range or by a promotion award of up to 10% more than their current basic salary excluding all allowances (whichever is the greater). Individuals appointed on level transfer will retain their existing basic salary excluding all allowances.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

SCS Pay Band 1

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

HO - Digital and Innovation Group - Chief Information Security Officer (CISO)

Type of role

Digital
Senior leadership

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Location: Croydon, Manchester, Glasgow, Sheffield and Cardiff.

About the job

Job summary

Why this role matters

The Deputy Chief Information Security Officer (Cyber Strategy, Governance, Risk and Compliance) is the senior accountable owner for the Home Office cyber governance, risk and compliance (GRC) function, cyber strategy, cyber security professional practice, and cyber business management function. The postholder provides enterprise-wide leadership and second-line assurance over cyber risk management, policy, standards and reporting, ensuring cyber risk is understood, owned and managed proportionately across the organisation.

Reporting directly to the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO), the role sets the strategic direction and operating model for cyber GRC, strategy, professional practice and business management, ensuring effective governance and decision-making through clear risk appetite, metrics and management information.

The role has leadership responsibility for the heads of governance, risk, compliance, business management, strategy and professional practice functions, ensuring the delivery of an integrated, high-performing capability that supports Home Office cyber security objectives.

The role leads capability planning, recruitment, career pathways and deployment of cyber professionals across Product Family Groups and Platforms, so the right skills and capacity are aligned to service criticality, delivery priorities and the threat landscape.

This is a senior strategic leadership role with enterprise-wide accountability for cyber security governance, risk and compliance and ownership of the Home Office cyber security professional practice. As the Deputy Chief

Information Security Officer (Cyber Strategy, Governance, Risk and Compliance), you will provide leadership across cyber GRC and professional practice, ensuring they align with and enable delivery of the overall Home Office Cyber Strategy. You will ensure that policies, standards, assurance and reporting remain aligned to the threat landscape, business priorities and government policy.

In addition, the role provides strategic leadership for the Cyber Business Management function, ensuring effective financial management, workforce planning, performance reporting, governance support, resource prioritisation and organisational effectiveness across the cyber security function. The postholder will ensure these activities operate effectively across the function and support delivery of the Home Office Cyber Strategy.

Job description

You will lead the cyber security professional practice, with accountability for capability planning, recruitment, career pathways, deployment and effective use of cyber professionals across the central cyber function and within digital delivery teams. Your leadership will thereby ensure the right skills and capacity are aligned to risk, service criticality and delivery priorities.

Your main day to day responsibilities will be:

- Owning and evolving the cyber security GRC and cyber practice strategy, ensuring alignment with Home Office priorities, Digital First Transformation Programme and cross government policy.
- Providing strategic leadership of second line cyber risk and assurance, including setting assurance priorities, aggregating and analysing enterprise cyber risk, and reporting clear, actionable insights to senior leadership and governance forums.
- Setting, maintaining and assuring enterprise cyber security policies, standards, frameworks and reusable patterns, ensuring they are proportionate, risk based and consistently applied across Product Family Groups and Platforms.
- Owning the cyber reporting framework, including defining metrics, dashboards and management information to support effective oversight of cyber risk, maturity and performance.

Leading the cyber security professional practice, including capability and workforce planning, recruitment, standards, career pathways, professional assurance and succession planning. Including, overseeing the prioritisation and allocation of cyber professionals, balancing demand, capacity and capability.

Building and sustaining strong, trusted relationships with senior business, digital, technology and security leaders across the Home Office and wider government, including representing the cyber GRC and practice function externally with bodies such as NCSC & UK Cyber Security Council.

Deputising for the CISO as required, including representing the function on the CISO Senior Management Team (SMT) and supporting senior decision-making and governance. Providing direct line management and leadership for multiple G6 leads

Person specification

Essential Criteria

You will have a demonstrable passion for cyber security, with proven experience operating at enterprise scale, and the ability to lead complex governance, risk and professional practice functions.

You will be able to demonstrate experience in:

Providing senior leadership for a large cyber security function, setting clear vision, strategy and operating models aligned to organisational priorities and government policy.

Influencing senior leaders and decisionmakers across business, digital, technology and security functions to embed effective cyber governance and risk ownership.

Providing authoritative advice, assurance and constructive challenge on cyber security matters at executive and board level.

Championing a strong cyber security culture, continuous improvement and value for money across the organisation.

For full list of requirements and skills for the role, please check the candidate pack attached at the bottom of the advert.

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £90,000, Home Office contributes £26,073 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

- Learning and development tailored to your role
- An environment with flexible working options
- A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity
- A Civil Service pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

Online Application

Please follow the Job Advert instructions on the Civil Service Jobs website to apply online by **23:55hrs on Sunday 8th November 2026.**

You will be asked to provide:

1. A **CV** (3 pages max) setting out your career history, highlighting specific responsibilities and achievements that are relevant for this role. Please provide reasons for any gaps within the last two years.

2. A **Statement of Suitability** (limited to 1250 words) providing examples of how your experience meets the essential criteria. This is your opportunity to give examples and show how your skills and experience fit the job requirements.

When writing a supporting statement, it is important that you:

Read the job specification so you are clear about the job requirements. Structure your personal statement to reflect the essential criteria listed in the advert.

Make sure you provide evidence against each of the listed criteria - i.e. experienced in leading high performing and diverse teams and promoting inclusivity. When have you led a team, how large, what did you do to promote inclusivity, how did you handle diversity?

Ensure any evidence you provide demonstrates the impact of your actions in that situation, provide statistical evidence where relevant.

For more information on how to write a personal statement, click here.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

This role has a minimum assignment duration of 3 years. An assignment duration is the period of time a Senior Civil Servant is expected to remain in the same post to enable them to deliver on the agreed key business outcomes. The assignment duration also supports your career through building your depth of expertise.

As part of accepting this role you will be agreeing to the expected assignment duration set out above. This will not result in a contractual change to your terms and conditions. Please note this is an expectation only, it is not something which is written into your terms and conditions or indeed which the employing organisation or you are bound by. It will depend on your personal circumstances at a particular time and business needs, for example, would not preclude any absence like family friendly leave. It is nonetheless an important expectation, which is why we ask you to confirm you agree to the assignment duration set out above.

Security

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	Home Office Digital SCS Recruitment
Email :	HODigitalSCSRecruitment@homeoffice.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email :	SCSRecruitment@homeoffice.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint you should contact

SCSRecruitment@homeoffice.gov.uk in the first instance. If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Home Office you can contact the Civil Service Commission.

Complaints should be sent in writing to:
Civil Service Commission, Room G8, 1 Horse Guards Road, London, *SW1A 2HQ.

Civil Service Commission

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